

August 20, 2026

Absolute Total Care (Centene)
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Eduardo Treviño (MRN MUSC3540441), Claim MUSC-B898-1

Patient	Eduardo Treviño (DOB 1971-02-01)
MRN	MUSC3540441
Member ID / Group	ABS836618976 / GRP-24383
Claim number	MUSC-B898-1
Date of service	2026-06-15
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	E78.5 — Hyperlipidemia, unspecified
Denied amount	\$528.12
Denial code	CARC 29 / RARC N211 — The time limit for filing has expired.
Appeal deadline	2026-10-21

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal appeal on behalf of Eduardo Treviño (Member ID: ABS836618976) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-B898-1 for services rendered on June 15, 2026, by Dr. Elena V. Castellanos, MD (NPI 1881726354) at MUSC Health University Medical Center. The claim was denied by Absolute Total Care (Centene) on July 23, 2026, under CARC 29 ("The time limit for filing has expired") with accompanying remark RARC N211 ("You may not appeal this decision"), with the payer's stated basis being that the claim was received after the contractual filing deadline. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and requests a full review and reversal, as the claim was submitted on July 2, 2026, well within any standard timely filing window measured from the June 15, 2026, date of service.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Treviño is a 55-year-old male with an active, longstanding diagnosis of hyperlipidemia (ICD-10 E78.5), documented as onset September 10, 2012. He has been managed continuously for this condition, with Simvastatin 10 mg ordered at regular annual intervals dating back to 2014, with the most recent active order placed on September 29, 2020. The June 15, 2026, encounter was a follow-up outpatient visit at MUSC Health University Medical Center (Place of Service 22) for ongoing management of his hyperlipidemia. The service was appropriately coded as CPT 99214, an established-patient office visit of moderate complexity, with a primary diagnosis of E78.5 and a secondary diagnosis of J06.9. The billed amount was \$528.12, with a payer-allowed amount of \$317.48 on file, confirming the service falls within covered benefits.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial under CARC 29 is factually unsupported. The date of service was June 15, 2026, and the claim was submitted to Absolute Total Care on July 2, 2026 — a span of only 17 days. Under any reasonable interpretation of standard Medicaid managed care contractual filing requirements, which commonly allow a minimum of 90 days and frequently up to 365 days from the date of service, a claim submitted 17 days post-service cannot be considered untimely. MUSC Health has no record of any notification from Absolute Total Care establishing a filing deadline shorter than 17 days, nor would such a requirement be consistent with applicable Medicaid managed care regulations or standard provider contract terms.

Furthermore, RARC N211 states that the denial may not be appealed. MUSC Health respectfully asserts that this remark does not extinguish the provider's right to dispute an erroneous denial. Applicable Medicaid managed care regulations and standard provider agreements preserve the right to seek reconsideration of claims denied on administrative grounds, particularly when the denial reason is demonstrably inconsistent with the documented submission record. Suppressing appeal rights on the basis of an administrative code does not relieve the payer of its obligation to process clean claims accurately and in good faith.

MUSC Health is prepared to provide system-generated claim submission confirmation and clearinghouse transmission records upon request to further substantiate the July 2, 2026, submission date.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Absolute Total Care (Centene) reverse the timely filing denial for Claim MUSC-B898-1, reprocess the claim on its merits, and issue payment at the contracted allowed amount of \$317.48 for CPT 99214 rendered on June 15, 2026. This appeal is being submitted through the secure provider portal in accordance with the plan's stated dispute process, within the appeal deadline of October 21, 2026. Should additional documentation — including clearinghouse submission records or clinical notes supporting medical necessity — be required to complete this review, MUSC Health will provide them promptly upon request.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record